

Not Investing in a Cloud Security Program can be Expensive

A well-planned cloud security program serves as the primary barrier against security breaches, protecting both the company's assets and its reputation. It's a crucial component that supports an organisation's overall health and in a world with more advanced cyber threats, it helps meet the basic compliance standards that stakeholders expect.



of inadequate security, such as data breaches and regulatory fines.

There is always a difference between simply meeting compliance checklists and barely passing the audits versus developing a thorough cloud security program. While compliance is just a starting point, it is never enough to guarantee security. A cloud security program demands investment, support from leadership, and continuous improvement. It must extend far beyond the basics of compliance to establish resilient defences.

The expensive consequences of regulations and non-compliance

Even major tech companies fail when it comes to regulations and non-compliance. Recently, a big tech company that failed to adhere to customer privacy and regulations was in the news. Imagine the same scenario for a well-funded startup that is acquiring some great customers. Suddenly, out of the blue, a regulator declares they aren't compliant. What happens to them? The organisation will lose business, and competitors will gain an edge. This is something a budding organisation would never want.

Consider the situation with Anthem, Inc., an insurance firm based in Indianapolis in the US. The company settled a class-action lawsuit for US\$ 115 million following accusations that it did not have sufficient information security measures in place. This lapse had resulted in a 2015 data breach that exposed the electronic protected health information (ePHI) of almost

As a security consultant with years of experience working with various emerging startups and well-established MNCs, I've observed a trend. As organisations live and die by strict budgeting, many still consider a cloud security program to be merely "nice to have." But they no longer have the luxury of thinking this way.

Gone are the days when we used extensive time and energy to manage our workloads in an on-premises environment. To better manage these resources, we began using a cloud service provider who could handle our workloads more efficiently than the traditional approach. This led to the rise of cloud computing, where provisioning and scaling of infrastructure started happening with just a couple of clicks.

As organisations grow, their business requirements evolve dynamically; they tend to use more advanced technology and cloud systems

to ease their work. Therefore, protecting important data and systems is more crucial than ever. This highlights the importance for organisations to have a strong security strategy.

A cloud security program is a long-term investment. It's like buying stocks—it doesn't pay off right away. Just like stocks grow over time, investing in a security program won't show immediate returns but can pay off greatly in the future.

The true costs of cloud security

Many organisations, particularly startups, often hold this belief that the cost of establishing a cloud security program, building a team, and procuring the necessary tools is excessively high. However, this thought fails to recognise the significant long-term benefits and cost savings that come with a well-implemented security strategy. This assumption overlooks the hidden costs